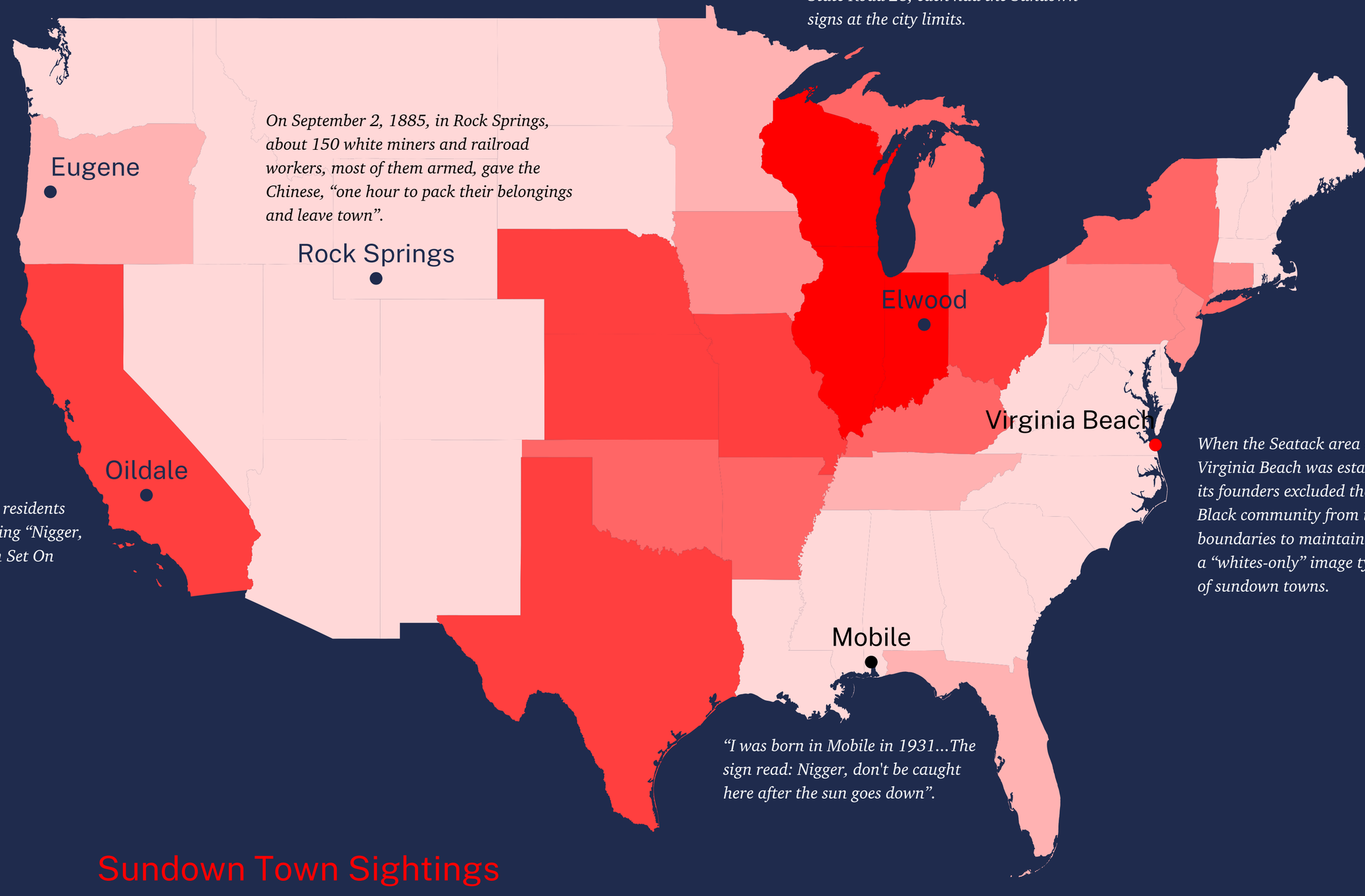
# Sundown Towns Sightings by State

## *“Nigger, don't be caught here after the sun goes down”*

Sundown towns emerged in the 1800s and used geographic boundaries to exclude Black and other non-white residents through violence, threats, signage, and local enforcement. Though often absent from official records, community memory, and research, archival evidence suggest thousands of U.S. towns practiced these forms of racial exclusion. Mapping and documenting sundown towns helps reveal how historical spatial exclusion continues to shape present-day segregation, resource distribution, and access to quality health care.

*One Indiana resident remembers that Tipton, Elwood and Alexandria, all on State Road 28, each had the Sundown signs at the city limits.*




*A string of towns along what is now Interstate 5 in western Oregon — including Eugene, Umpqua, Grants Pass, Eagle Point, and others — primarily excluded African Americans.*

*On September 2, 1885, in Rock Springs, about 150 white miners and railroad workers, most of them armed, gave the Chinese, “one hour to pack their belongings and leave town”.*

*Several long time residents tell of a sign reading “Nigger, Don't Let The Sun Set On You in Oildale”.*

*When the Seatack area of Virginia Beach was established, its founders excluded the Black community from its boundaries to maintain a “whites-only” image typical of sundown towns.*

*“I was born in Mobile in 1931...The sign read: Nigger, don't be caught here after the sun goes down”.*

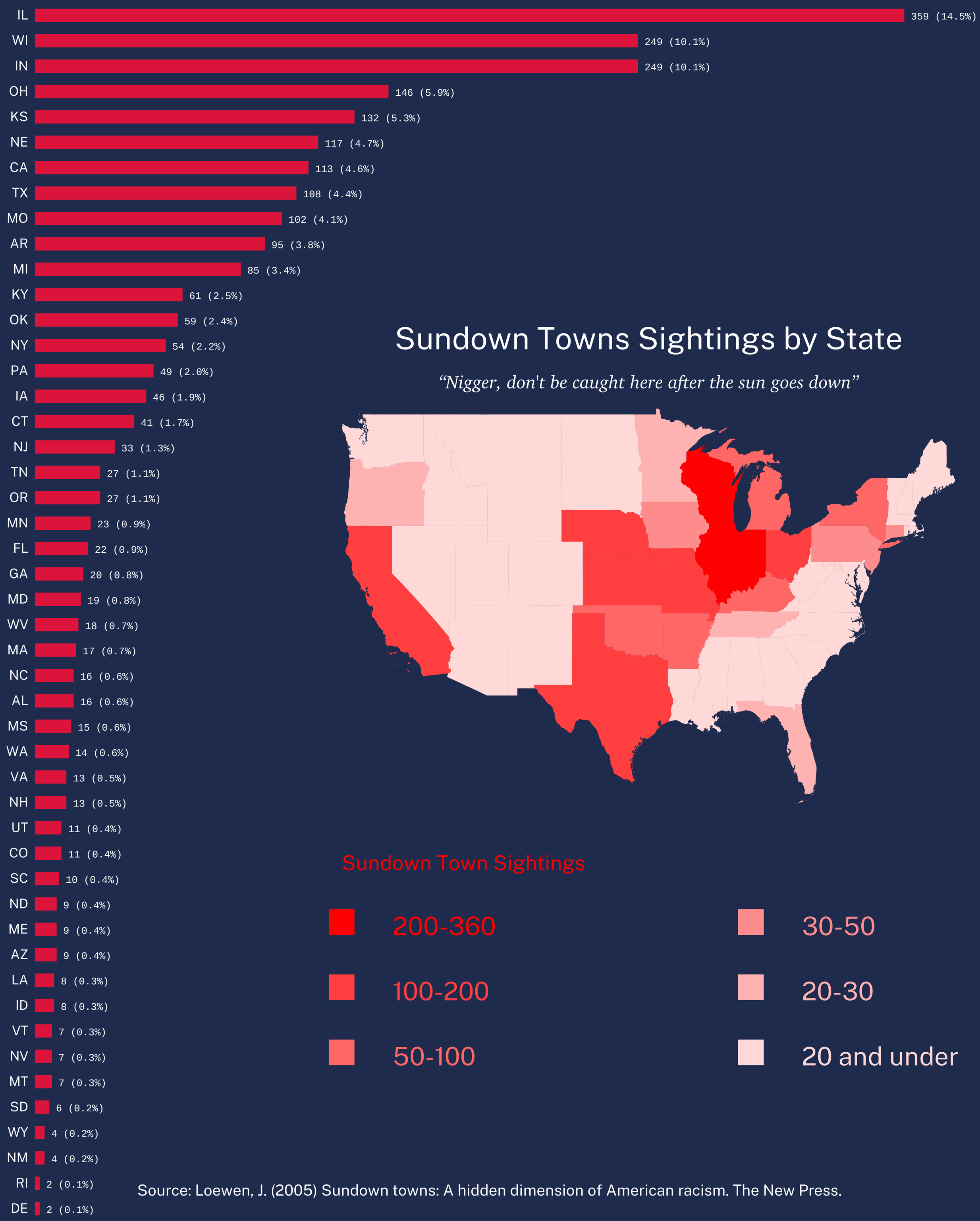
Sundown Town Sightings

- 200-360
- 100-200
- 50-100
- 30-50
- 20-30
- 20 and under

Source: Loewen, J. (2005) Sundown towns: A hidden dimension of American racism. The New Press.

Conception and Research: Leia Belt (lbelt@ucmerced.edu)

Visual Engineering: Anthony Starks (ajstarks@ajstarks.org)

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